Statistics

Five steps with guiding questions to help you understand and analyze the primary source

1 **Identify the Source**	Who created these statistics? What is the source?
	What type of statistics are they? Charts, graphs, tables, or something else?
2 **Place the Source in Context**	What is the historical context for these statistics?
	What time, place, and topic or topics do these statistics cover?
3 **Analyze the Source Content**	What do these statistics reveal? What conclusions can you draw by analyzing the data?
	Do these statistics show a change over time or difference across regions or differences across other subjects?
	Do these statistics include a guide or commentary to help you interpret them?
4 **Assess the Source Perspective**	Do you think the compiler of these statistics had a particular perspective or bias?
	Do you think these statistics are accurate?
	Do these statistics support or contradict your own conclusions?
5 **Evaluate the Source**	What can you learn by analyzing the data in these statistics?
	Do you think these statistics are useful? Are they important?
	What connections can you make from these statistics to politics, issues, culture and society, faith and religion, historical change over time, etc.?
	How can you connect these statistics into key themes, questions, controversies, and debates? How can you connect these statistics into questions you have?